

JSM 2026 ENVR Graduate Student Mentoring Session

Mentor Information Handout

Tuesday, August 4, 2026, 12:00–1:00 PM EDT

Thomas M. Menino Convention & Exhibition Center, Room CC-259A

Doug Nychka



Doug Nychka
Colorado School of
Mines
Academia

Doug Nychka is a leading statistician in spatial statistics, environmental statistics, and climate applications. His work has had broad influence on statistical methods for large spatial and geophysical datasets, uncertainty quantification, and statistical modeling for environmental science. He has extensive experience mentoring students and early-career researchers and can offer valuable perspectives on building a research program, developing interdisciplinary collaborations, and navigating academic and research careers in environmental statistics.

Possible discussion topics

- Academic career development
- Spatial statistics and environmental applications
- Climate and geophysical data analysis
- Interdisciplinary research collaborations
- Research leadership and mentoring

Career path represented: Academic research and environmental statistics

Amy Braverman



Amy Braverman
NASA Jet Propulsion
Laboratory
Government Laboratory

Amy Braverman is a statistician at NASA Jet Propulsion Laboratory whose work focuses on statistical methods for Earth science, satellite data, uncertainty quantification, and the analysis of complex geophysical datasets. Her career illustrates the important role statisticians play in government laboratories and large interdisciplinary scientific teams. She can provide students with insight into careers in mission-driven research environments, statistical collaboration with scientists, and the use of statistics to address major questions in Earth and environmental science.

Possible discussion topics

- Careers in government laboratories
- Statistics for Earth science and satellite data
- Uncertainty quantification
- Interdisciplinary scientific collaboration
- Professional development outside traditional academic departments

Career path represented: Government research and applied environmental statistics

Dorit Hammerling



Dorit Hammerling

Colorado School of
Mines
Academia

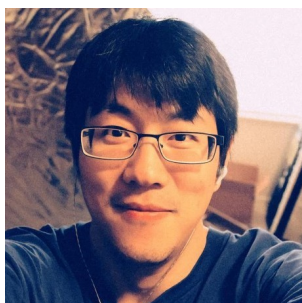
Dorit Hammerling is a statistician whose research focuses on environmental statistics, climate science, spatial and spatio-temporal modeling, and uncertainty quantification. Her work connects modern statistical methodology with high-impact scientific questions related to climate and environmental systems. She brings valuable experience in academic mentoring, interdisciplinary collaboration, and research leadership, and can advise students interested in climate statistics, environmental data science, and academic career pathways.

Possible discussion topics

- Climate statistics and environmental data science
- Spatial and spatio-temporal modeling
- Academic career preparation
- Collaborative research with domain scientists
- Building a research identity in environmental statistics

Career path represented: Academic research, climate statistics, and interdisciplinary science

Zhen Zhang



Zhen Zhang

Otsuka Pharmaceutical
Industry

Zhen Zhang is a statistician working in industry and brings an applied perspective on the role of statistics in scientific decision-making, collaborative research, and professional practice outside academia. His career path provides students with insight into industry opportunities for statisticians, the transition from graduate training to applied statistical work, and the skills needed to succeed in collaborative and fast-paced professional environments.

Possible discussion topics

- Industry career pathways
- Applied statistics in professional settings
- Transitioning from graduate school to industry
- Communication and collaboration skills
- Long-term professional development

Career path represented: Industry and applied statistics

Sponsored by the ASA Section on Statistics and the Environment (ENVR)